

Car Rental Request Automation in ServiceNow

Using Service Catalog and Flow Designer
SkillWallet - ServiceNow Global Certification Program
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1. Ideation

Idea. Employees who need a car for official work usually depend on manual coordination (calls, emails, follow-ups) to request, approve and assign one. This project automates the whole process inside ServiceNow using the Service Catalog and Flow Designer.

Objectives

- Provide one standard Service Catalog item for car rental requests.
- Automate the manager approval step.
- Automatically assign a task to the Transport team once a request is approved.
- Reduce manual coordination and errors.
- Track every request in a single, centralized system.
- Keep requesters informed through automatic notifications.

Skills used: Service Catalog, Flow Designer and process automation, Update Sets (batch updates), business rules and client scripting.

2. Requirement Analysis

Functional scope

- Service Catalog item for car rental requests.
- Form with variables: requested date, pickup location, drop location, duration, car type and reason.
- Approval workflow that routes the request to a manager.
- Task automation that creates an assignment task for the Transport team.
- Email notification to the requester when the request is approved.
- All configuration tracked and moved through an Update Set.

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Expectation
End users (requesters)	Employees requesting a car	Easy request form, quick approval, visible status
Managers (approvers)	Approve or reject requests	Simple, structured approval process
Transport team	Fulfil approved requests	Clear request details and automatic task assignment
ServiceNow admins	Configure catalog, flows, notifications	Flexible, easy-to-maintain automation

System requirements

- A ServiceNow instance with administrative access.
- Access to the Service Catalog module.
- Flow Designer (workflow engine) for automating the request process.

3. Project Design

Data architecture

- Request details are stored in ServiceNow's Service Catalog tables: Request (REQ), Requested Item (RITM) and Catalog Task (SCTASK).
- Workflow data (progress and decision history) is captured in the task and approval tables.
- Car availability and assignment details can be kept in a Car Inventory table or an external data source.
- All requests, approvals and notifications are logged for auditing and reporting.

Interface design

A clean Service Catalog form lets users submit a request with dates, locations and car preference. The Service Portal shows request status, approvals and notifications, while managers and admins use the ServiceNow back end to review requests and monitor availability.

Catalog variables

Variable	Type	Name
Requested Date	Date	requested_date
Pickup Location	Single Line Text	pickup_location
Drop Location	Single Line Text	drop_location
Duration	Numeric Scale	duration
Car Type	Select Box (Mini, SUV, Sedan)	car_type
Reason	Multi Line Text	reason

Navigation flow

- 1 The user opens the car rental catalog item and fills in the form.

- 2 The user clicks **Order Now** and receives a Request number (REQ).
- 3 Opening the request shows the Requested Item (RITM).
- 4 The manager opens the RITM and approves the request.

4. Project Planning

The project is split into milestones that follow the build order:

Phase	Focus	Est. duration
Phase 1	Requirement Analysis and Planning	59 min
Phase 2	Backend Development and Data Architecture (Update Set, catalog item, flow design)	3 h
Phase 3	UI/UX Development and Customization (interface design, navigation, usability)	1 h 39 min
Phase 4	Data Migration, Testing and Security (automation, workflow attachment, update set)	-
Phase 5	Deployment, Documentation and Final Presentation	-

Roadmap milestones: Catalog item creation, form setup, workflow design, task automation, notifications, testing, deployment and business rules. A single Update Set tracks and deploys all configuration.

5. Project Development

Milestone 1: Update Set

Create an Update Set so every configuration change is captured and can be moved to another instance.

Milestone 2: Service Catalog

- 1 Open ServiceNow, click **All** and search for **Maintain Items**.
- 2 Click **New**, fill in the catalog item details and click **Save**.
- 3 Scroll down to **Variables** and create the six variables listed in the design section.
- 4 In the Car Type variable, add the choices **Mini**, **SUV** and **Sedan**, then save the item again.

Milestone 3: Flow Designer

- 1 Click **All**, search for **Flow Designer**, then click **New > Flow**.
- 2 Name the flow **Car Rental Req**, open *Show additional properties*, set *Run as* to **System User** and click **Build Flow**.
- 3 Add a trigger: choose **Service Catalog** and click **Done**.
- 4 Add the action **Ask for Approval**: drag in the Requested Item record, set the Approval field, set the journal field to Approval History and choose an approver.
- 5 Add an **If** condition (approval state is Approved) using the data pill picker.

- 6 Inside the condition, add **Create Catalog Task** on the **sc_task** table, assign it to the **Transport team**, add a description and include the catalog variables.
- 7 Add the action **Send Email**: send to the requester (using the catalog variable pill), with the subject "Your Car Request is approved" and a short message body.
- 8 **Save** the flow, click **Test** and verify each step executes.

Milestone 4: Attach workflow and finalize

Link the flow to the catalog item so every submitted request automatically follows the approval and processing steps. The workflow reads the form data, triggers approvals, creates tasks and sends notifications. Finally, finalize the Update Set and move it to the target instance.

Outcome

An employee submits a car rental request from the catalog. The flow sends it to a manager for approval. Once approved, a task is created for the Transport team and the requester receives a confirmation email. The process is faster, consistent and fully traceable.